

FOLLOW / FOLLOWING / FOLLOWER

1. Passage anchor

> “Over the **following months**, Kelvin accompanied him to physiotherapy sessions and helped more at home.”

Passage meaning

following = coming after a particular time or event; subsequent

接下來的；隨後的；之後的

Here, **the following months** means the months that came after Kelvin’s father returned home and began recovering.

Practice

1. His health improved over the **following weeks**.

他的健康狀況在**接下來幾星期**逐漸改善。

2. The **following day**, she returned to work.

第二天 / 翌日，她回去工作。

Core meanings of FOLLOW

2. follow — go or move behind someone

= move behind someone who is going somewhere

跟著；跟隨

Examples

1. **Follow me**.

跟著我。

2. The child **followed her mother** into the shop.

那個孩子**跟著母親**走進商店。

This is the central physical sense.

3. follow someone somewhere

= go behind someone to the same place

跟隨某人前往某處

Examples

1. She **followed him into the room**.

她**跟著他走進房間**。

2. We **followed the guide downstairs**.

我們**跟著導遊下樓**。

Pursue / trail someone

4. follow — go after someone in order to observe or pursue them

= keep moving behind someone, sometimes secretly

跟蹤；尾隨

Examples

1. He realized that someone was **following him**.

他發現有人正在**跟蹤他**。

2. The detective **followed the suspect**.

探員**尾隨嫌疑人**。

Context determines whether **follow** is innocent “跟著” or suspicious “跟蹤”.

Come after in order

5. follow — come after something

= happen, exist, or appear after something else in time or sequence

接著發生；在……之後

Examples

1. A long silence **followed**.

接著是一段長時間的沉默。

2. Several difficult months **followed the accident**.

事故之後**接連出現**幾個艱難的月份。

6. be followed by

= have something come next

之後接著是.....；隨後有.....

Examples

1. Dinner was **followed by** dessert.

晚餐**之後接著是**甜品。

2. The speech was **followed by** questions.

演講**之後進入**提問環節。

Very common passive construction.

FOLLOWING — subsequent

7. following — next / subsequent

As an adjective:

= coming after something in time or order

接下來的；隨後的；下一個的

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The **following morning**, he called again.

第二天早上 / 翌晨，他又打來電話。

2. Sales increased in the **following year**.

銷售在**隨後一年**有所增加。

8. the following

= the person, thing, information, etc. that comes next

以下內容；下列事物 / 人士

Examples

1. Please answer ****the following questions****.
請回答****以下問題****。

2. We need ****the following items****.
我們需要****下列物品****。

9. following — after an event

As a preposition in formal use:

= after something happened
****在……之後****

Examples

1. ****Following the meeting****, we changed the plan.
****會議之後****，我們修改了計畫。

2. The road reopened ****following the accident****.
道路在事故****之後****重新開放。

Formal alternative to ****after****.

Follow a route / path

10. follow — travel along a route

= move along the direction of a road, path, river, route, etc.
****沿著……走；順著……前進****

Examples

1. ****Follow the road**** until you reach the bridge.
****沿著這條路走****，直到到達大橋。

2. We ****followed the path**** through the forest.
我們****沿著小徑****穿過森林。

11. follow directions

= go according to given navigation instructions

****按照方向指示走****

Examples

1. Just ****follow the directions**** on your phone.
只要****按照手機上的導航指示走****。
2. We got lost because we did not ****follow the directions**** carefully.
我們因沒有仔細****按指示走****而迷路。

Obey instructions / rules

12. follow — obey or act according to

= do what instructions, rules, advice, procedures, etc. say

****遵從；按照；依照****

Examples

1. Please ****follow the instructions**** carefully.
請仔細****按照指示****。
2. Everyone must ****follow the rules****.
每個人都必須****遵守規則****。

Major abstract sense.

13. follow advice

= act according to advice given

****聽從建議****

Examples

1. She ****followed the doctor's advice****.
她****聽從了醫生的建議****。
2. If you ****follow this advice****, the process should be easier.
如果你****按照這項建議去做****，過程應該會更容易。

14. follow orders

= obey instructions given by someone in authority

****服從命令****

Examples

1. The soldiers were told to ****follow orders****.

士兵被要求****服從命令****。

2. He said he was simply ****following orders****.

他說自己只是****奉命行事****。

15. follow a procedure / process

= carry out steps in the required order

****按照程序 / 流程進行****

Examples

1. Please ****follow the correct procedure****.

請****按照正確程序****進行。

2. Staff must ****follow the safety process****.

員工必須****遵循安全流程****。

Understand

16. follow — understand what someone is saying

= understand an explanation, argument, story, conversation, etc. as it develops

****聽懂；理解；跟得上****

Examples

1. Sorry, I don't quite ****follow you****.

抱歉，我不太****明白你的意思****。

2. The explanation was difficult to ****follow****.

那個解釋很難**理解 / 跟上**。

Major learner sense.

17. easy / difficult to follow

= easy/difficult to understand as it progresses

容易 / 難以理解

Examples

1. Her presentation was easy to **follow**.

她的簡報很**容易理解**。

2. The plot became hard to **follow**.

情節變得很**難跟得上**。

Follow a story / discussion

18. follow — keep track mentally

= understand and keep track of events or ideas as they develop

跟上 ; 掌握

Examples

1. I found it hard to **follow the story**.

我覺得很難**掌握故事情節**。

2. Are you **following the discussion**?

你**跟得上這場討論**嗎？

Observe developments

19. follow — pay attention to developments

= watch, read about, or keep informed about an event, subject, person, etc.

關注 ; 追蹤

Examples

1. I have been **following the case** closely.
我一直密切**關注這宗案件**。

2. She **follows international news**.
她會**留意 / 關注國際新聞**。

20. follow a sport / team / artist

= regularly take an interest in and keep informed about
關注；追隨

Examples

1. He closely **follows basketball**.
他很**關注籃球**。

2. She has **followed the band** for years.
她多年來一直**關注 / 追隨這支樂隊**。

Social media

21. follow — subscribe to someone's updates

= choose to receive or see updates from a person, organization, account, etc. on social media
追蹤；關注

Examples

1. I **follow her on Instagram**.
我在 Instagram 上**追蹤她**。

2. Thousands of people **follow the account**.
有數千人**關注這個帳號**。

Major modern sense.

22. follower — social media subscriber

= person who follows an account online

****追蹤者；粉絲****

Examples

1. The account has a million ****followers****.
這個帳號有一百萬名****追蹤者****。
2. She gained thousands of new ****followers****.
她新增了數千名****粉絲 / 追蹤者****。

Follower — supporter

23. follower — supporter / believer

= person who supports, admires, or believes in a person, movement, teaching, religion, etc.
****追隨者；信徒；支持者****

Examples

1. The leader attracted many ****followers****.
那位領袖吸引了很多****追隨者****。
2. He was a ****follower of**** that philosophical tradition.
他是那個哲學傳統的****追隨者****。

Copy an example / pattern

24. follow — imitate an example

= behave or act in the same way as someone or something used as a model
****仿效；效法****

Examples

1. Other companies soon ****followed their example****.
其他公司很快便****仿效他們的做法****。
2. She decided to ****follow her mother's example****.
她決定****效法母親****。

25. follow in someone's footsteps

= do the same kind of work or live in a similar way to someone before you

****追隨某人的腳步；繼承某人的道路****

Examples

1. He ****followed in his father's footsteps**** and became a doctor.
他****追隨父親的腳步****成為醫生。

2. She had no desire to ****follow in her sister's footsteps****.
她並不想****走姐姐走過的路****。

Very high-value idiom.

26. follow suit

= do the same thing that another person has just done

****跟著做；照樣做****

Examples

1. One company cut prices, and others ****followed suit****.
一家公司減價後，其他公司也****跟著照做****。

2. He stood up, and everyone else ****followed suit****.
他站起來，其他人也****跟著站了起來****。

Very common idiom.

Pursue a career / course / interest

27. follow a career / profession

= pursue a particular kind of work or professional path

****從事；走上.....職業道路****

Examples

1. She decided to ****follow a career in medicine****.
她決定****從事醫療行業****。

2. He **followed a career in engineering**.

他走上了**工程專業道路**。

Less common than **pursue a career**, but established.

28. follow one's interests / passion

= pursue activities that match one's interests

追隨 / 發展自己的興趣

Examples

1. She chose to **follow her passion for music**.

她選擇**追隨自己對音樂的熱愛**。

2. He left the job to **follow his interests**.

他辭去工作，去**發展自己的興趣**。

Result logically

29. follow from something

= happen or be true as a logical or natural consequence of something

由.....導致；由.....推論而得

Examples

1. It does not necessarily **follow from** the evidence that he was responsible.

並不能必然**從證據推論出**他需要負責。

2. Several consequences **follow from** this decision.

這項決定會**帶來**幾個後果。

Major formal sense.

30. it follows that

= it can logically be concluded that

由此可見；因此可以推論

Examples

1. If both statements are true, **it follows that** the conclusion is correct.
如果兩個陳述都是真的，**由此可以推論**結論正確。

2. It does not **follow that** everyone will agree.
這並**不代表** / 不能推論出**所有人**都會同意。

Very high-value academic construction.

Result in time / causation

31. what followed

= what happened afterwards

之後發生的事

Examples

1. Nobody expected **what followed**.
沒有人預料到**接下來發生的事**。

2. **What followed** changed the company completely.
之後發生的事情徹底改變了公司。

Follow instructions on page/screen

32. follow a link

= use/click a hyperlink to go to another page or resource

點擊 / 開啟連結前往

Examples

1. **Follow the link** to complete your registration.
點擊該連結完成登記。

2. Users can **follow the link** for more information.
使用者可以**開啟連結**查看更多資料。

This grows naturally from “proceed along a route.”

Follow references / citations

33. follow a reference

= use a reference, citation, or pointer to locate further information

****按引用 / 指示查找資料****

Examples

1. ****Follow the reference**** to the original study.
****按照引用資料****查找原始研究。
2. Readers can ****follow the citation**** for further details.
讀者可以****依據引用****查看更多細節。

Follow up

34. follow up

= take further action after an earlier event, contact, problem, treatment, etc.

****跟進；後續處理****

Examples

1. I'll ****follow up**** with the customer tomorrow.
我明天會再****跟進客戶****。
2. The doctor asked her to ****follow up**** in two weeks.
醫生叫她兩星期後再來****覆診 / 跟進****。

Extremely high-value modern phrasal verb.

35. follow up on something

= investigate, check, or take further action concerning something

****跟進某事****

Examples

1. Police are ****following up on the report****.

警方正在**跟進這份報告**。

2. I need to **follow up on that email**.

我需要**跟進那封電郵**。

36. follow-up — noun

= further action, meeting, message, examination, etc. after an earlier one

跟進；後續行動

Examples

1. We scheduled a **follow-up meeting**.

我們安排了**跟進會議**。

2. The patient needs a **follow-up** next month.

病人下個月需要**覆診 / 跟進檢查**。

Follow through

37. follow through

= continue an action, plan, promise, etc. until it is completed

貫徹到底；完成到底

Examples

1. She made a plan and **followed through**.

她制定了計畫，並且**貫徹到底**。

2. You need to **follow through on your promise**.

你需要**履行承諾到底**。

Very useful figurative phrasal verb.

38. follow-through

A. completion of promised/intended action

貫徹執行；後續落實

B. sport: continuation of body/racket/club movement after striking

****擊球後的順勢動作；隨揮動作****

Examples

1. The idea was good, but there was little ****follow-through****.
想法很好，但缺乏****後續落實****。
2. A good golf swing requires proper ****follow-through****.
良好的高爾夫揮桿需要正確的****隨揮動作****。

Follow along

39. follow along

= continue watching, listening, reading, or doing something together with another person or source
****跟著進行；跟著看 / 讀 / 做****

Examples

1. Open the book and ****follow along****.
打開課本，****跟著一起看****。
2. It was difficult to ****follow along**** with the demonstration.
很難****跟上那個示範過程****。

Follow somebody around

40. follow someone around

= repeatedly go wherever someone goes
****一直跟在某人身邊 / 到處跟著****

Examples

1. The puppy ****followed me around**** all day.
小狗整天都****到處跟著我****。
2. The child kept ****following her mother around****.
那個孩子一直****跟在媽媽身邊****。

Depending on context, it can be affectionate, annoying, or suspicious.

Follow one's nose

41. follow one's nose — navigation

= go straight ahead or go in the direction one instinctively thinks is right

憑直覺找路；一直往前走

Examples

1. Just **follow your nose** until you reach the square.

只要**一直往前走**，直到廣場。

Figurative

= trust one's instinct

憑直覺行事

2. Sometimes you just have to **follow your nose**.

有時你只能**相信自己的直覺**。

Follow the crowd

42. follow the crowd

= do what most other people are doing rather than decide independently

隨大流；跟風

Examples

1. He tends to **follow the crowd**.

他往往會**隨大流**。

2. Don't just **follow the crowd**—make your own decision.

不要只會**跟風**，要自己作決定。

As follows

43. as follows

= used to introduce a list, explanation, set of instructions, etc.

如下；如下所示

Examples

1. The results are **as follows**.

結果**如下**。

2. The procedure is **as follows**.

程序**如下所示**。

Important fixed construction.

Note:

> **as follows**

not:

>  as follow

>  as following

Following on from

44. following on from

Especially BrE:

= continuing from or resulting from something earlier

接續.....；承接.....

Examples

1. **Following on from** our earlier discussion, we changed the plan.

承接之前的討論，我們修改了計畫。

2. This research **follows on from** earlier work.

這項研究**延續了**之前的工作。

Useful formal connection.

FOLLOWER

45. follower — person who follows another physically

= person moving behind someone else

****跟隨者****

Possible, but less common than the abstract meanings.

46. follower — supporter

= person who supports or admires someone, an idea, movement, religion, etc.

****追隨者；支持者；信徒****

Examples

1. The movement gained many ****followers****.

這場運動得到很多****追隨者****。

2. He became a devoted ****follower**** of the teacher.

他成為那位老師忠實的****追隨者****。

47. follower — person who copies others

= person who tends to copy rather than lead

****跟隨別人的人；缺乏主見者****

Examples

1. He sees himself as a leader, not a ****follower****.

他認為自己是領導者，而不是****跟隨別人的人****。

2. She has never been much of a ****follower****.

她一向不是那種****只會跟著別人的人****。

FOLLOWING — group of supporters

48. following — supporters / audience

As a noun:

= group of people who regularly support, admire, read, watch, or listen to someone or something
支持者群；粉絲團；追隨者

Examples

1. The singer has a large **following**.

那名歌手有龐大的**粉絲團**。

2. The website developed a loyal **following**.

那個網站累積了一群忠實的**支持者**。

Very common.

High-value contrasts

49. follow vs go with

follow

= move behind someone

跟在後面

go with

= accompany someone, usually together rather than behind

和某人一起去

Compare:

> Follow me.

> 跟著我走。

> Come with me.

> 跟我一起來。

50. follow vs chase

follow

= go after someone; may be calm or neutral

跟隨；跟蹤

chase

= actively pursue in order to catch someone or something

****追趕****

Compare:

> The dog followed me home.

> 狗一路跟著我回家。

> The dog chased the cat.

> 狗追趕那隻貓。

51. follow vs obey

****obey****

= do what a person, command, or rule requires

****服從****

****follow****

= broader; act according to instructions, advice, rules, procedure, etc.

****遵循；按照****

Compare:

> obey the officer

> 服從警員

> follow the instructions

> 按照指示

52. follow vs understand

****understand****

= broad ability to grasp meaning

****理解****

****follow****

= understand something ****as it develops step by step****

****跟得上；理解其進展****

Compare:

> I understand the concept.

> 我理解這個概念。

> I can't follow your argument.

> 我跟不上你的論證思路。

53. follow vs monitor

****monitor****

= systematically observe something to check its condition or progress

****監察；監測****

****follow****

= keep informed about or pay continuing attention to

****關注；追蹤****

Compare:

> monitor a patient's heart rate

> 監測病人的心率

> follow the news

> 關注新聞

54. follow vs track

****track****

= actively record or trace location, progress, movement, or data

****追蹤；記錄****

****follow****

= broader; pay attention to developments or go behind someone

****跟隨；關注****

55. following vs next

****next****

= immediately after the present/mentioned one

****下一個；接下來的****

****following****

= coming after something already mentioned; may refer to a subsequent period or item

****隨後的；接下來的****

Compare:

> next month

> 下個月

> in the following months

> 在那之後的幾個月

In the passage, ****following**** looks backward to the previous event and means ****the months after that event****.

56. following vs after

****after****

= general preposition/conjunction/adverb

****在.....之後****

****following****

= more formal preposition meaning ****after****, or adjective meaning ****subsequent****

Compare:

> after the meeting

> 會議之後

> following the meeting

> 會議之後 (較正式)

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****follow**** is:

****come or move after something****

From this develop several major branches.

A. Physical movement

Person

follow me

→ **跟著我**

Suspicious pursuit

someone followed me

→ **有人跟蹤我**

Route

follow the road

→ **沿路走**

B. Sequence

Time

the following months

→ **接下來的幾個月**

Event

silence followed

→ **之後出現沉默**

Passive

followed by dessert

→ **之後接著甜品**

C. Act according to something

Instructions

follow instructions

→ **按照指示**

Rules

follow rules

→ **遵守規則**

Advice

follow advice

→ **聽從建議**

D. Understand

Argument

follow an explanation

→ **理解 / 跟上思路**

Story

follow the plot

→ **掌握情節**

E. Keep informed

News

follow a story

→ **持續關注新聞事件**

Social media

follow an account

→ **追蹤帳號**

F. Copy / emulate

Example

follow someone's example

→ **仿效某人的做法**

Footsteps

follow in someone's footsteps

→ **走相似的人生 / 職業道路**

Crowd

follow the crowd

→ **隨大流**

G. Consequence / logic

follow from

→ **由.....導致 / 推論而得**

it follows that

→ **由此可見 / 可以推論**

H. Continued action

follow up

→ **跟進**

follow through

→ **貫徹到底**

The semantic thread is highly coherent:

something comes after, stays with, or proceeds according to something that came before.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
follow — move behind	跟在某人 / 某物後面移動；跟隨
follow someone somewhere	跟著某人前往同一地方
follow — pursue secretly	跟蹤 / 尾隨某人
follow — come after	在時間或次序上接著出現 / 發生
be followed by	之後接著出現 / 發生某事

following — subsequent	在之前提及的事件 / 時間之後出現的 ; 接下來的	
the following	以下 / 下列將要列出的內容	
following — preposition	正式 : 在.....之後	
follow a route/path/road	沿著某條路線 / 道路前進	
follow directions	按照方向 / 導航指示走	
follow — obey/act according to	遵循規則、指示、方法等	
follow instructions	按照指示行事	
follow advice	聽從 / 按照建議	
follow orders	服從命令 / 奉命行事	
follow a procedure/process	按照規定程序 / 流程進行	
follow — understand	理解說話、解釋或論證的進展 ; 跟得上	
easy/difficult to follow	容易 / 難以理解其內容或進展	
follow a story/discussion	掌握並跟上故事 / 討論的發展	
follow — track developments	持續關注某事件、人物或主題的最新發展	
follow a sport/team/artist	長期關注某運動、球隊、藝人等	
follow — social media	在社交媒體上追蹤 / 關注某帳號	
follower — online	社交媒體帳號的追蹤者 / 粉絲	
follower — supporter	支持或信奉某人、團體、思想等的追隨者 / 信徒	
follow an example	仿效 / 效法某人的做法	
follow in someone's footsteps	走與某人相似的人生 / 職業道路	
follow suit	看見別人做某事後也照樣做	
follow a career	從事 / 走上某種職業道路	
follow one's passion/interests	追隨、發展自己的興趣 / 熱愛	
follow from	作為某事的自然 / 邏輯結果而產生	
it follows that	由此可以推論 / 因此可見	
what followed	之後發生的事情	
follow a link	點擊 / 開啟連結以到達指定頁面	
follow up	在之前事件後採取進一步行動 ; 跟進	
follow up on something	對某件事進行後續查問、處理或調查	
follow-up — noun/adjective	跟進 / 後續的會議、檢查、行動等	
follow through — complete	把計畫、承諾或行動貫徹到底	
follow-through — action	把原定行動真正落實到底	
follow-through — sport	擊球後延續的隨揮 / 順勢動作	
follow along	跟著別人 / 教材一起看、聽、讀或進行	
follow someone around	到處一直跟著某人	
follow one's nose	憑直覺找路 / 行事	
follow the crowd	不獨立判斷而跟著大多數人做 ; 隨大流	
as follows	用來引出下列內容 ; 如下	
following on from	承接 / 延續先前的事情	
following — supporter group	某人 / 作品等累積的支持者群、粉絲團	

Passage recap

> “Over the **following months**, Kelvin accompanied him to physiotherapy sessions and helped

more at home.”

Here:

****following**** = ****coming after the event or period just mentioned****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****接下來的****

* ****隨後的****

* ****之後的****

Natural contextual translation:

****在接下來的幾個月裡，Kelvin 陪父親去做物理治療，也在家裡幫忙更多。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****following****

= ****coming after something previously mentioned in time or sequence****

****接下來的；隨後的****

The biggest learner splits are:

> ****follow me****

> → ****跟著我****

> ****follow the road****

> → ****沿著道路走****

> ****follow the instructions****

> → ****按照指示****

> ****follow the rules****

> → ****遵守規則****

> ****I don't follow you****

> → ****我不明白你的意思****

> ****follow the news****

> → ****關注新聞****

> ****follow someone online****

> → ****在網上追蹤 / 關注某人****

> **follow someone's example**

> → **仿效某人**

> **it follows that...**

> → **由此可推論.....**

> **follow up**

> → **跟進**

> **follow through**

> → **貫徹到底**

And for the exact passage construction:

> **the following months**

> does **not** mean "months that are following someone."

It means:

the months that came next after the event just described

→ **接下來的幾個月**

So the passage uses the **temporal-sequence** branch of a very productive word whose underlying idea is consistently **coming after, staying with, or proceeding according to something else**.